technology transfer could only take place after the pandemic phase was over and the regular supply phase had begun. This was rather strange, since they had already committed to transfer technology to a Chinese firm called Shanghai Fosun Pharmaceutical.[4] Also, the clauses in the contract which they were making countries sign were very problematic to say the least—not only could countries *not* hold them liable for bad batches of doses but also had to indemnify them against adverse effects, supply delays or even total failure to supply. Even more frightening were clauses which prevented countries from introducing any potential drugs which would emerge as a cure for COVID-19 before Pfizer received authorization. To top this, countries would have to pay in full the cost of ordered doses regardless of authorization or delivery delays or a quality problem. In the event they failed to do so, it would be considered as breach where no domestic law of the land would hold and the jurisdiction of the courts of New York would have the power to acquire current and future sovereign assets of the purchasing country until all dues—for the vaccines as well as all legal fees—were paid.[5] In fact, alarming reports later surfaced about how Pfizer failed to reach a deal with Brazil and Argentina because the company engaged in 'high-level bullying' during negotiations to come to a deal. They attempted to hold developing Latin American countries to ransom by asking them to put up federal bank reserves, embassy buildings or military bases as guarantee against the actual cost of the vaccines and also future legal cases stemming from adverse effects of their vaccines.[6]

At the same time, NEGVAC connected Dr Reddy's Laboratories in India to Russian Direct Investment Firm and Gamaleya to commence adaptive Phase II/III clinical trials for the Sputnik V vaccine. Adopting a technology transfer model, Dr Reddy's would mass-produce and distribute the vaccine in India. Interestingly, Dr Reddy's has never manufactured vaccines and not only did NEGVAC successfully connect them to the Sputnik team but also ensured that Dr Reddy's tied up with six Indian companies to further pass on technology to manufacture Sputnik.

Similarly, Johnson & Johnson, in partnership with Biological E in India, had also begun Phase I/II trials in the country on a technology transfer model. In this case too, since the technology platform that Biological E used was one which would attack the receptor-binding domain (RBD) subunit—a crucial step in the process of how the infection spreads in the body—the required raw materials needed to be imported. Not only did the